

USUCGER Annual Meeting

MINUTES

Sunday March 26, 2023

Room 501A Los Angeles Convention Center

2:30 PM Pacific Time

Adda Athanasopoulos-Zekkos, USUCGER President, Presiding

Attendance:

- Adda Athanasopoulos-Zekkos (President), Scott Olson (Past President), Joseph Coe (Treasurer), Matt Evans, James Kaklamanos, Diane Moug, Kristin Sample-Lord (Webmaster), Jack Montgomery, and Bret Lingwall (Secretary).
- Also, in attendance were 16 unique USUCGER members and several non-faculty guests

Welcome:

- Call to Order at 2:30PM
- Introductions of all the board members and attendees.

General Committee Business:

- Outgoing members of the board were recognized and thanked
- An election will be held in Fall of 2023 for two new positions, one junior and one senior. The nominating committee will be formed in August to develop a pool of candidates for the election.
- An NSF informational session was held with Dr. Giovanna Biscotin (NSF program officer), youtube recording link was distributed to the membership for those who could not attend.
- Awarded 5 student travel grants for GeoCongress 2023

Treasurer's Report:

- Bank Balance of \$49,529, with \$500 in paypal.
- New dues drives is continuing, About ½ have paid for the new cycle. Others need to pay soon! There has been a legacy of non-payment that the board is trying to mitigate through a high portion of dues payments.
- Bank account being transferred from Tong to Joseph officially this weekend while Joseph is in LA and can be physically present at the bank.
- No special projects were awarded in 2022 to make budget room for the upcoming USUCGER young faculty development workshop.
- Feedback from the membership on the threatening to remove from USUCGER.
 - A suggestion from Bill Kitch was to focus more on recruiting of new persons to USUCGER as an alternative means of raising enrollments into USUCGER, as there are many more geotechnical faculty out there in the US that are not participating in USUCGER than are on the current roles.

- It may be time to update the name of the lead person at each institution, as there have been retirements and other departures that have changed who the current contact information is at the institution.

Webmaster's Report:

- Check your SPAM filter to make sure that USUCGER messages are coming through. Contact the webmaster and/or institutional IT for help on getting email screening tool settings correct so that the listserv comes through.
- When sending emails, just email all@usucger.org and the entire membership should receive it, pending any moderator approvals by the webmaster.
- Kristen can help with website and listserv problems or questions. Please contact her!
- Website update and transfer to non-OSU host has been completed.
- Send adds for new faculty to Kristen, she can easily add your new faculty advert to the website.
- Dues payment process has been amended after a wealth of excellent feedback from the membership.
- Dues are not prorated... the dues are \$75 for the three-year dues cycle per person.
 - If you are paying for multiple people, there is an important last step on the payment process. If you miss the step, just email Kristen!

Additional Business:

- Special Projects
 - The Project from Iowa State University under direction of Dr. Cassie Rutherford and Dr. Bena Ajmera was awarded the 2022-2023 special project.
 - The topic is game-based design learning of geotechnical topics.
 - Another solicitation will come out again in fall of 2023 for the 2023-2024
- Awards
 - The following awards were made, and the awardees were recognized by the USUCGER membership:
 - No nominations were received for the Distinguished Service Award, and so none were awarded in this cycle.
 - Early Career Researchers:
 - Professor Michelle Barry, University of Arkansas
 - Professor Alba Yerro-Colom of Virginia Tech
- Early Career Workshop
 - Was delayed due to the funding situation at NSF. Will be held at Texas Austin with Dr. Kumar as the host for the event.
- GI board updates were given by Sissy Nicolaou
 - GI will be hosting the 2024 Innovation Initiative from ASCE. ASCE has identified that GI is the leader in innovation, and GI will be pushing out geotechnical innovation contests in the next year.
 - USUCGER members should be more involved in the GEOSTRATA magazine.
 - GI is working on branding of geotechnical engineering to raise business profile of the industry and the risks of commoditization.
 - Perhaps a special projects theme for a specific direction tied to helping GI larger mission.

- Geo-Coalition update
 - DFI is looking for local DFI members who can work to support their local university with deep foundations related topics, tours, resources to help enable deep foundations teaching at universities, as the content at many schools are not covering key deep foundations topics nowadays.
 - DFI committees have ability to submit research proposals for funding. For faculty who are interested in research funding, get involved with DFI committees!
 - Canadian Geotechnical Society has been reaching out to younger generations and encourages cross-border cooperation in outreach specific to geologic and geotechnical engineering.
- Mentoring Initiative and Associated Ad-hoc Committee
 - The ad-hoc committee plays matchmaker for junior faculty who seek a mentor through USUCGER. These are led by Matt Evans.
 - Matt will be gaging interest again in 2023-2024 from the junior faculty ranks for interest and for senior faculty to join a committee on the topic.
 - Giovanna would like to highlight the importance to this effort, since NSF panels have become virtual and the lack of in-person panel service has led to the interaction and networking dropping off over the last three years, with no sign of ending.

Questions and Comments from the Membership:

- Is there a way for those who send out the emails to the listserv to get a confirmation that the email went out.
- Help for Post-Docs and transitions through grad to post-doc to faculty.
 - This is what the early career workshop is all about

Election of the New USUCGER President:

- Adda was thanked for her service!
- With Adda rotating off the board, it is time to elect a new president. Per the by-laws, this must be a current USUCGER board member, not entering their last year of the board membership.
- The following persons on the board have expressed interest in being president, and are eligible to be nominated: Jack Montgomery of Auburn University
- From the nominations, A unanimous election count of members present.
- Therefore, Jack Montgomery was elected as President of USUCGER for the next year. Adda will move to the role of past president for the next year.
- Jack accepted! Scott Olson is now released from USCUGER service.

Adjourn at 4:10 PM after a Motion and Second